Revising and Editing Refresher

In the Writing section you fix and improve short passages. **Revising** makes writing clearer and better organized; **editing** corrects grammar and conventions. (Standards 10B, 10C, 10D.)

Revising — Making Writing Better (10B ★, 10C ★)

- **10B · Structure & development ★** — A strong piece has an **introduction, transitions, coherent paragraphs, and a conclusion** (10B·i) and develops ideas with **specific facts, details, examples** (10B·ii).
- **10C · Revising for quality ★** — Improve **clarity, development, organization, style, word choice, and sentence variety.** Combine choppy sentences; cut repetition; choose precise words.

Worked example. "The dog was big. The dog was loud. The dog ran." → "The big, loud dog ran across the yard." (sentence variety)

Editing — Correcting Conventions (10D)

- **10D·i · Complete sentences ★** — Complete sentences with **subject-verb agreement**; avoid run-ons, comma splices, fragments.
- **10D·ii · Verb tense & voice ★** — Keep tenses consistent; use active/passive voice correctly.
- **10D·iii · Prepositions ○** — Use correctly; don't let them confuse subject-verb agreement. **10D·iv · Pronoun-antecedent ○** — Match pronoun to noun in number and gender.
- **10D·v · Capitalization ○** **10D·vi · Punctuation ○** — Commas in nonrestrictive phrases/clauses, **semicolons, colons, parentheses.**
- **10D·vii · Spelling ★** — Including confusables: **its/it's, affect/effect, there/their/they're, to/two/too.**

Worked example (agreement). "The box of markers *are* on the desk." → subject is *box* (singular): "The box of markers **is** on the desk." (the phrase *of markers* doesn't change the subject)

> **Watch Out:** *Its* = belonging to it; *it's* = it is. *Their* = belonging to them; *there* = a place; *they're* = they are. Tested often.

Try It. Fix: "Me and him walked to there house." → *(He and I walked to their house.)*

Short Constructed Response (SCR) Mastery

The Reading section includes **2 Short Constructed Responses**, each worth **2 points.** You write a few sentences that answer a question and back it up with **evidence from the text.** (Builds on response standards 6C and 6D.)

Score	What it means
2	A **correct, clear answer** fully supported with **accurate text evidence** and a brief explanation
1	A partially correct answer, or weak/vague/incomplete evidence
0	An incorrect answer, no text evidence, or blank/off-topic

Key Idea: Two points = **answer + evidence + explanation.** Leaving out the evidence is the most common way students lose a point.

The A-E-E Structure

1. Answer the question directly. **2. Evidence** — quote or paraphrase a specific detail. **3. Explain** how it supports your answer. Stems: *The text shows that… · For example, the author writes "…" · This proves that…*

Worked Example

Prompt: *How does the narrator feel about moving to a new town? Use evidence from the text.*

Full credit (2): The narrator feels **nervous and sad** about moving. The text says she "stared at the empty walls of her old room and felt her stomach tighten." This shows she is anxious because her familiar home is gone. *— clear answer + quotation + explanation.*

Partial (1): The narrator feels bad about moving because she doesn't want to go. *— reasonable, but no text evidence or explanation.*

No credit (0): I would feel excited to move to a new place. *— personal opinion, not the narrator's feelings; no evidence.*

Strategy: Keep it to three or four focused sentences. Always include one specific detail or short quotation. Answer the exact question asked — don't drift into your own opinion unless the prompt asks for it.

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) Mastery

The Writing section includes **1 Extended Constructed Response** — a full multi-paragraph essay worth **10 points**, tied to a reading passage. It is the single biggest-point task on the RLA test.
(Composition standards 11B informational, 11C argumentative, 11D correspondence; and 6B comparing sources.)

What the Essay Must Have

- A clear **central idea or claim** (thesis).
- **Coherent organization** — introduction, body paragraphs, conclusion.
- **Sufficient development** — specific **evidence** and explanation, not general statements.
- **Effective language and conventions** — varied sentences, precise words, correct grammar.

> **Key Idea:** Points come from a clear thesis, organized paragraphs, and **specific evidence** explained in your own words. A blank or one-paragraph answer cannot score high.

A 4-Step Essay Plan

1. **Plan (2–3 min).** Decide your thesis; jot 2–3 supporting points and the evidence for each.
2. **Introduction.** Hook + topic + **thesis/claim.**
3. **Body paragraphs (2–3).** One point each: state it → give **evidence** → **explain** it. Use transitions.
4. **Conclusion.** Restate the thesis in fresh words; leave a final thought.

Argumentative tip: Name the **counter-argument** and answer it ("Some may say…, but…").

Annotated Sample (Argumentative, shortened)

Prompt: *Should students have longer recess?*

Many schools are cutting recess, but students actually learn better with more of it. *(claim)* First, recess gives the brain a break. The article states that "students who move during the day focus longer in class." *(evidence)* This shows play is not wasted time. *(explanation)* In addition, recess builds friendships and reduces stress. Some argue recess takes away learning minutes, **but** rested students finish work faster. *(counter-argument answered)* For these reasons, schools should give students longer recess. *(conclusion)*

Score band	What it looks like
High (8–10)	Clear thesis, well organized, specific evidence explained, strong conventions

Middle (4–7)	A thesis and some organization, but thin evidence or several errors
Low (1–3)	Unclear or missing thesis, little development, many errors
0	Blank, off-topic, or too brief to score

Strategy: Plan for a couple of minutes before writing — an organized essay almost always scores higher than a longer, messy one. Always use **evidence from the passage**, and leave a minute to check spelling and punctuation.